

UX REPORT – UDEMY

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

IZ Maduna 22555740

G Mohuba 23545527

TL Mokwena 22496336

IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN B

23 August 2026

1. Introduction

Udemy (udemy.com) is a large online learning marketplace offering courses across a wide range of subjects, taught by independent instructors. It was chosen as a reference point for this evaluation because it is one of the most widely recognised online course platforms and, notably, uses a card/cell-based catalogue layout (the exact pattern the client has explicitly asked us to move away from). Evaluating Udemy lets the group measure, rather than assume, how a card-based catalogue performs on efficiency and target-acquisition, directly informing a Fitt's-Law-compliant, list-based redesign.

2. Methodology

- We utilized a shortened version of the User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S), which was scored using a 7-point semantic differential scale.
- **Participants:**
 - We had 3 individuals per site, referred to as P1, P2, and P3 for anonymity in each group.
- **Pages evaluated:** Course Catalogue and Course detail page
- **Procedure (the same for all three reports):**
 - Open the website
 - Spend approximately 2–3 minutes exploring the **course catalogue page**.
 - Click on a course of interest and spend 2–3 minutes on the **course detail page**.
 - Return to the form and answer the questions.
 - There are no right or wrong answers; participants answered based on personal experience
- **Scale:** 7-point semantic differential across 8 criteria:
 - Obstructive – Supportive
 - Complicated – Easy

- Confusing – Clear
- Boring – Exciting
- Conventional – Innovative
- Usual – Modern
- Inefficient – Efficient
- Not Interesting – Interesting

3.Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	22
P2	21
P3	26

4.UEQ Results

4.1 Course Catalogue & Course Detail Experience (combined)

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Boring – Exciting	4	4	3	3.7
Conventional – Innovative	6	5	4	5.0
Usual - Modern	5	6	5	5.3
Inefficient – Efficient	5	5	4	4.7
Not Interesting – Interesting	6	5	3	4.7

5. Findings & Discussion

The **highest-scoring criteria were "Modern" (5.3) and "Innovative" (5.0)**. Udeemy's card-grid catalogue clearly reads as visually contemporary and polished. This is likely driven using thumbnail imagery, badges (bestseller, ratings), and a familiar e-commerce-style grid that participants recognise from other shopping platforms.

The **lowest-scoring criterion was "Boring – Exciting" (3.7)**, the only score to dip below the neutral midpoint, followed closely by **"Efficient" (4.7)**, which sits only marginally above neutral. The Efficient score is the most directly relevant to Fitt's Law: a near-neutral rating suggests participants did not experience the catalogue as clearly fast or easy to act on. This is consistent with how card layouts are typically structured: the clickable/interactive area is often limited to a thumbnail image or title, surrounded by non-interactive padding, meta-text, and icon buttons (e.g. a small wishlist heart). By Fitt's Law, this produces smaller, less predictable target areas and therefore slower, more error-prone pointing, whether by mouse or by touch.

This pattern directly supports the client's frustration: cells look modern, but the *practical* act of scanning, comparing, and selecting a course is not rated as strongly efficient. The redesign brief is therefore not simply a stylistic preference: it is measurable friction that a list-based layout, with larger and more consistent click targets, can directly address. One limitation to note: because only one Pragmatic Quality item (Efficient) was included, this data cannot fully separate *findability* from *sortability* from *raw click efficiency*. Qualitative task-completion notes (e.g. how long it took participants to locate

a course, or whether they used Udemy's filter/search tools) would strengthen this section if available.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

- Make the entire list row the clickable target (title, thumbnail, description snippet, and metadata together), rather than isolating the click area to the title or thumbnail alone.
- Position sort and search controls in a fixed, predictable location at the top of the list so users don't need to relocate them between visits.
- Avoid isolating small interactive icons (e.g. Wishlist, add-to-cart) inside a card; where such actions are needed, give them generous padding and clear spacing from other targets to reduce mis clicks.
- Maintain sufficient vertical spacing between list rows so that adjacent targets don't compete for the same pointing motion, lowering error rate as predicted by Fitt's Law.
- Preserve visual polish (imagery, ratings, badges) within the list format so the "Modern"/"Innovative" strengths of the card layout are not lost in the move to a list; efficiency and visual appeal are not mutually exclusive.

7. Conclusion

The Udemy evaluation shows that a card-based catalogue can score well on visual modernity and novelty, but only marginally above neutral on efficiency, the dimension most directly tied to Fitt's Law and to the client's core complaint. This supports the

group's direction of a list-based catalogue with a large, full-row click targets and fixed sort/search controls, while retaining the visual richness that made Udemy's design feel current.